

The Best Places to Eat Rösti

Kronenhalle expensive

In Switzerland, many fashionable city eateries either don't serve rösti or reinterpret them into dainty patties. However, at Kronenhalle there's no fooling around with the rösti; it's the real thing – a large, rich, buttery potato cake that's eaten with the restaurant's Châteaubriand steak, Wiener schnitzel, or veal bratwurst.

This establishment has been home to Zurich's *crème de la crème* for generations and has a collection of art by masters such as Miró and Chagall. Whether you're in the front room or one of the two dining rooms, the buzzy atmosphere is that of a chock-a-block brasserie rather than a hallowed hall of gastronomic distinction (although the food is very savvily done). With so much history – it opened its doors in 1862 – to go with the art and the beautiful people, the Kronenhalle is quintessential Zurich.

Rämistrasse 4, Zurich; open noon–midnight daily; www.kronenhalle.ch

Also in Zurich

Once the home of the city's mayor, the building housing **Restaurant Bierhalle Kropf** (www.zumkropf.ch; *moderate*) is a magnificent piece of heritage, dating back to the Middle Ages; try their house specialty of *Würstplatte* – a selection of sausages – *mit Rösti*. At the **Rössli** (www.roessli-zollikon.ch; *moderate*) in Zollikon, an upmarket area just outside the downtown, try your rösti with calf liver, garlic, onions, and herbs. **Zunftthaus zur Haue** (www.zunftthaus-zur-haue.ch; *moderate*) serves its *Geschnetzeltes mit Rösti* with added calf kidney for that extra zing.

Also in Switzerland

Lucerne's iconic **Wirtshaus Galliker** (+41 41 240 10 02; *moderate*) is a bastion of homely Swiss cooking, with rösti galore. **Café du Grütli** (www.cafedugruetli.ch; *inexpensive*) in Lausanne serves up Swiss classics with rösti including local *saucisse à rotir* (roast sausage). **Restaurant Schnabel** (www.restaurant-schnabel.ch; *moderate*) in Basel has a whole selection of rösti dishes as main courses as well as accompaniments to liver dishes such as the Basel specialty *Suuri Läberli* (sour beef liver).

Around the World

In Canada, order rösti as a side dish with the Swiss classic *emincé de veau à la Zurichoise* (strips of veal cooked in a cream sauce) at Montreal's **La Raclette** (www.laraclette.ca; *moderate*). In Hong Kong, **Chesa** (www.peninsula.com; *moderate*), at the Peninsula Hotel, serves rösti (which they pronounce "roastee") with both *Geschnetzeltes* (listed on the menu by its French name, *emincé de veau*) and bratwurst (see pp130–1).



Above Zurich is a city of sober efficiency and clean streets, served by a smooth-running network of trams and trolley buses

Left Classic Swiss rösti may be served with a fried egg on top as a weekday meal, or as an accompaniment to veal or liver dishes